LESSON 6

Rain, Rain, Go Away

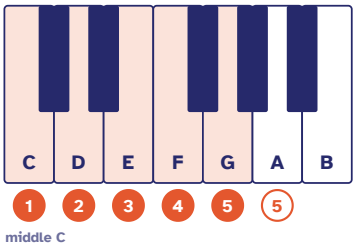
An old English nursery rhyme, sung to send the rain away so the children can go out and play.

IN THIS SONG **a new note: A** **finger 5 stretches** **letters on C and G**

LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

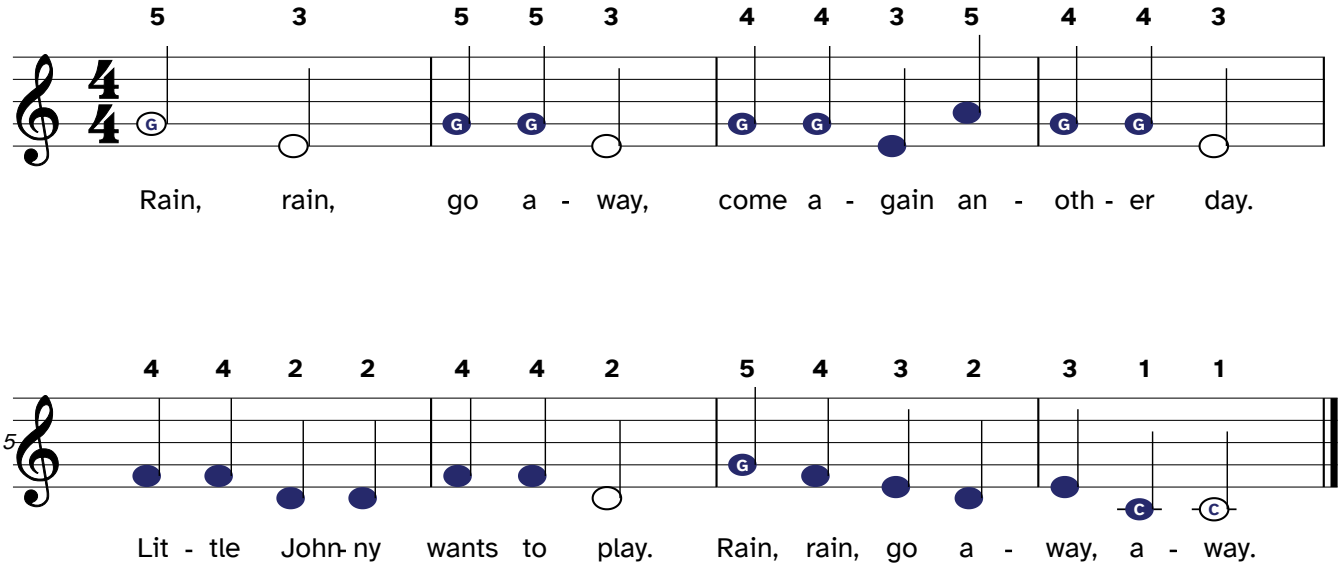
1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. Sing it with the words; watch for the one A, in bar 3.



Your hand: the C position, and one key more. Thumb on middle C. Finger 5 stretches one key up to A, then comes home. Right next to A, G is played with 4.

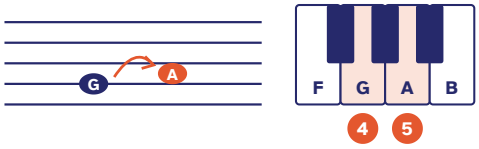
Only C and G keep their letters. A is one step above G: the space just over line 2.



☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.



NEW IN THIS SONG

A, one step above G: the space just over line 2, the white key next to G. Finger 5 reaches up to it; G takes 4.

More in the Handbook: Pitch 1 · The keyboard, Pitch 2 · The staff

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

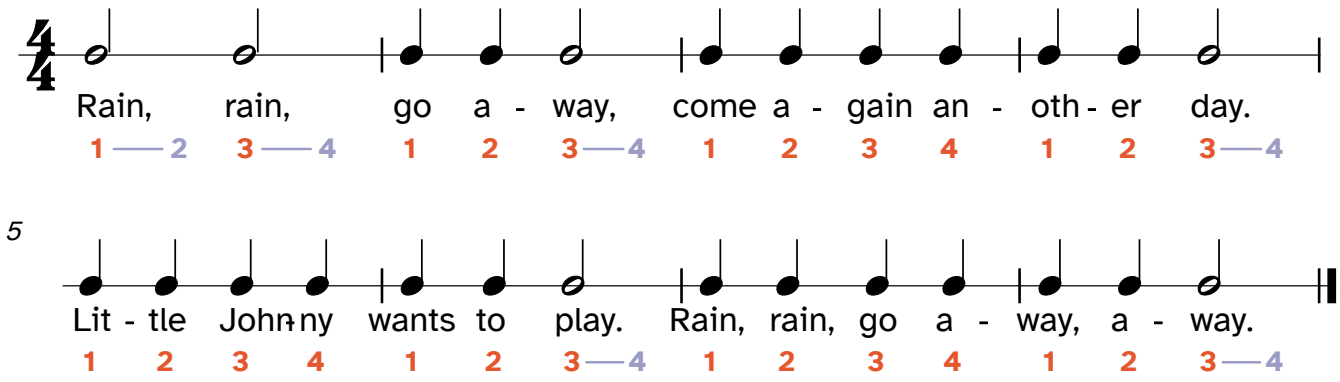
THE TIME

Top 4: four beats in every bar.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

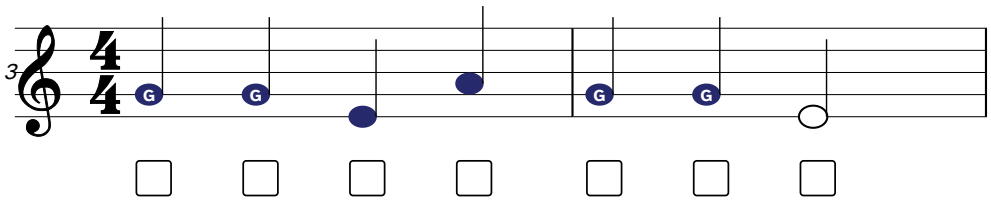
crotchet: walk
1 beat

minim: hold
2 beats



THE NOTES

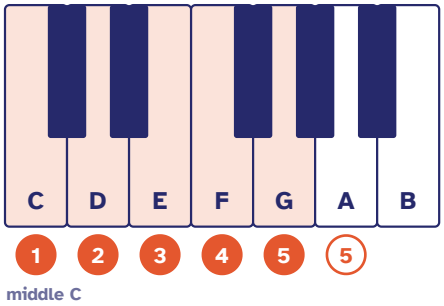
Only C and G are named. Write the letter under each note of bars 3 and 4: count up or down from them, and find the A.



- [ ] **Said it in time**
- [ ] **Clapped and counted**
- [ ] **Wrote the letter names**
- [ ] **Found A, one step above G**

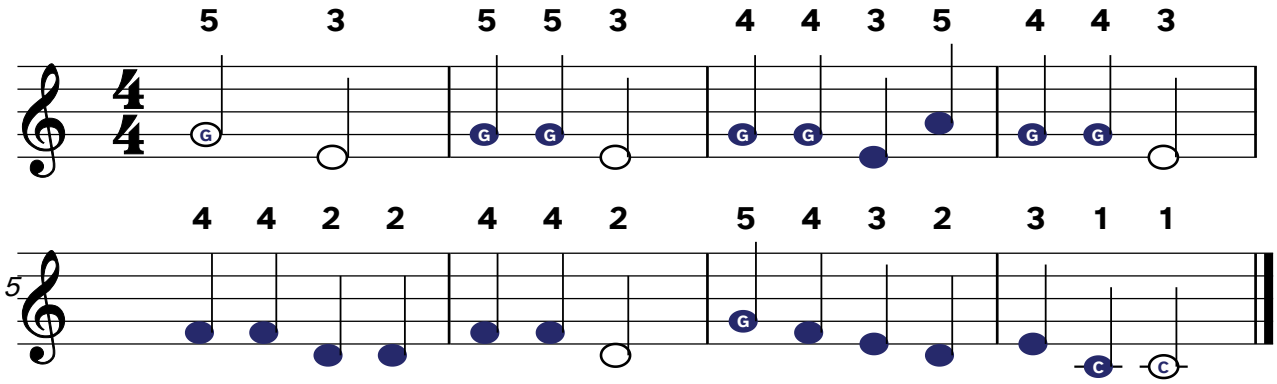
3 Play it

The C position with one stretch: finger 5 reaches up to A. The right hand, then the left.

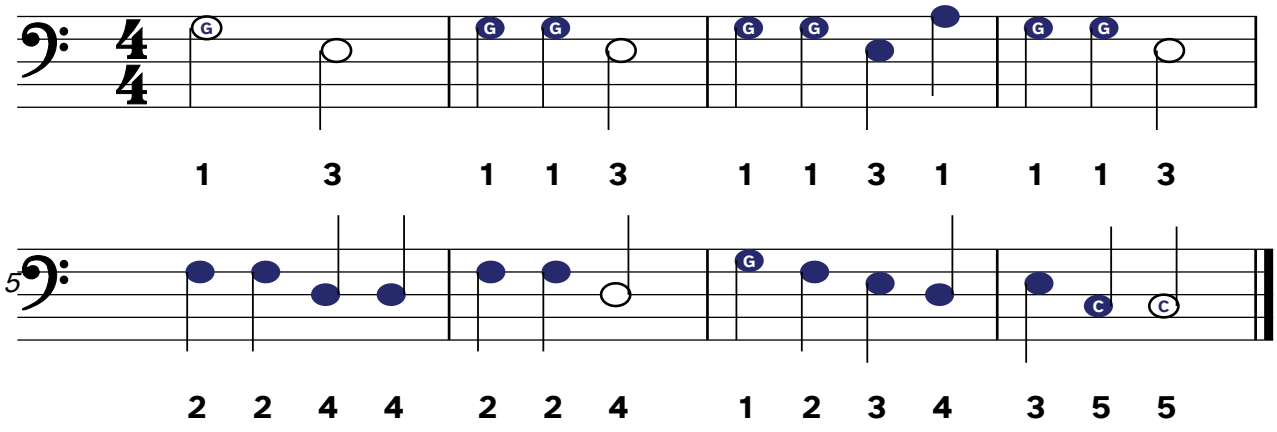


Right hand: thumb on middle C, 1 to 5 up to G; 5 stretches to A.
Left hand: an octave lower, on the King's staff. Thumb on G, stretching up to A; down to 5 on C.

R RIGHT HAND the C position



L LEFT HAND the King's staff, an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can stretch 5 to A and come back

I can play it:

- ☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

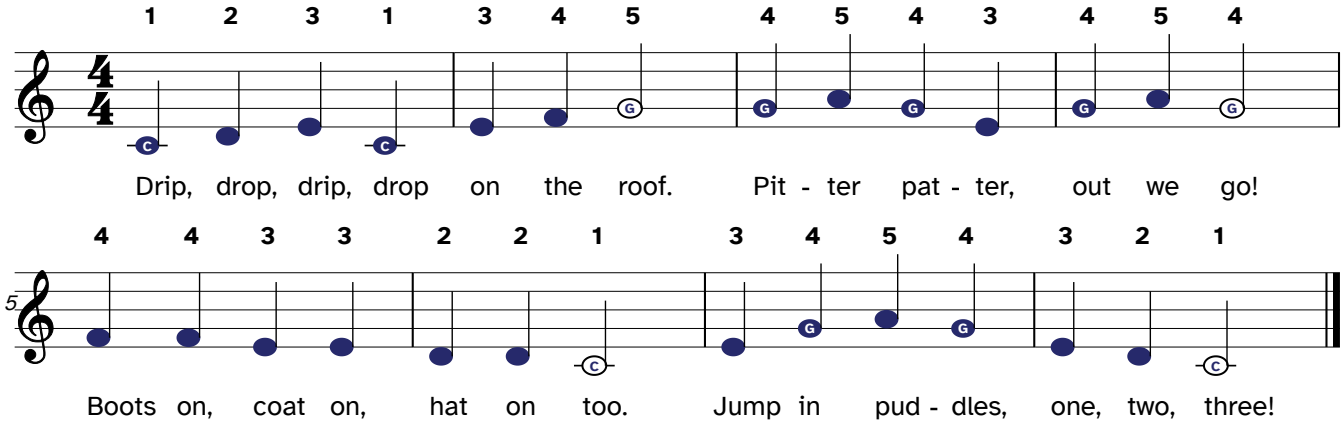
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

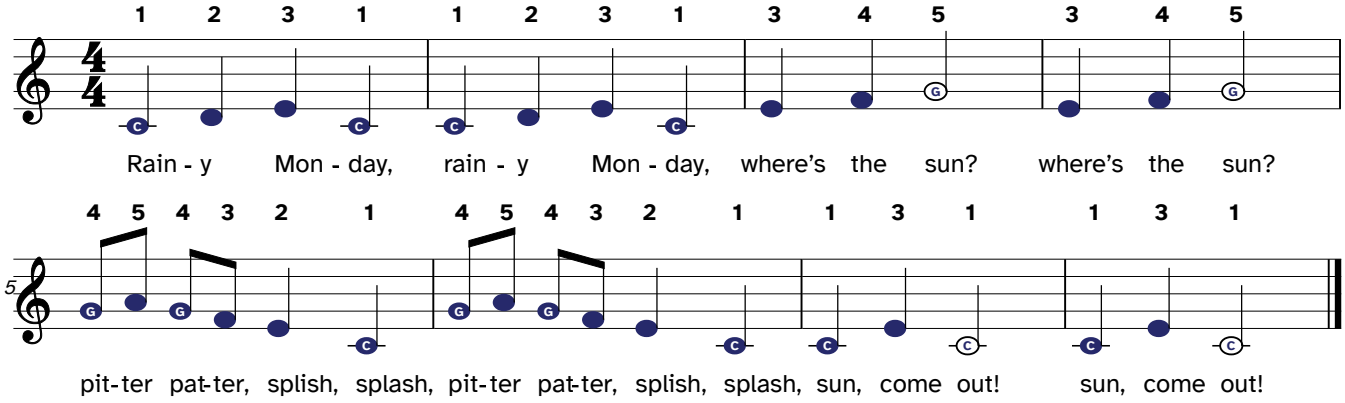
PITTER PATTER

A comes again and again: G with 4, A with 5, then home to G.



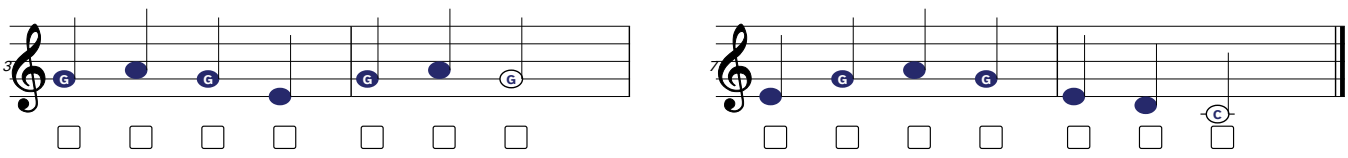
RAINY MONDAY

A peek at Lesson 7: every line comes twice, the way Frère Jacques does. The quick notes G A G F take 4 5 4 3, then E with 2 and C with the thumb.



NAME THE NOTES, A TOO

Only C and G wear their letters. Count from them to name the others, and find the new A, one step above G. Write each in its box.



☐ **Played the first tune** ☐ **Played the second tune** ☐ **Named the notes, A too**